

MOVING IN A HOUSTON SUMMER



WHAT NOBODY WARNS YOU
ABOUT UNTIL YOU'RE LIVING IT

*A former Houston nurse and Realtor shares
real-life advice to keep your move safe,
smart, and stress-free in extreme heat.*



BEAT THE
HEAT



PROTECT YOUR
BELONGINGS



PACK
SMARTER



TIME IT
RIGHT



THE ULTIMATE HOUSTON SUMMER MOVING CHECKLIST

TIPS, SAFETY GUIDE & CHECKLIST INSIDE

A RELOCATION GUIDE FROM

The Ultimate Houston Summer Moving Guide

*Real, lived-in advice for surviving — and thriving
through — a move in Houston's toughest season.*

BY FAY BRINK // REALTOR & FORMER RN

Welcome

“
If you're holding this guide, you're either about to move through a Houston summer, or you're smart enough to be planning ahead for one. Either way, I'm glad you're here.

Before I was a REALTOR®, I was a nurse. And before that, I lived through Hurricane Katrina as a volunteer and Hurricane Harvey as a Houstonian — so when I tell you Houston heat is not something to take lightly, I'm not being dramatic. I've seen what it does to the body, and I've personally moved through more than one Houston July myself. It is, plainly, brutal.

That combination — nursing and real estate — shapes how I advise every client who moves through my door, and it's exactly why this guide reads differently than a generic moving checklist. You'll find real medical guidance here: how to recognize heat exhaustion before it becomes heat stroke, what actually happens to your body in a Houston attic in August, and when a symptom means you stop what you're doing and call for help. You'll also find the practical, sometimes unglamorous tricks I've picked up moving my own life more times than I'd like to admit — wrapping dresser drawers instead of emptying them, freezing water bottles the night before, why your fridge should be the very last thing loaded and the very first thing unloaded.

Houston doesn't make moving easy in the summer. But with the right plan, it doesn't have to be dangerous, either. That's what this guide is for.

Whether you're buying, selling, or simply trying to get your family safely from one Houston address to another, I hope this becomes something you actually use — dog-eared, coffee-stained, checked off box by box. And if you need a hand with anything real-estate-related along the way, you know where to find me.

Fay Brink

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Your Planning Timeline

The single best thing you can do for a Houston summer move is start early — every task you finish before the heat becomes a factor is a task you're not fighting through triple digits later.

**8 WEEKS
OUT**

Begin emptying the attic, garage, and storage areas — the hottest, most dangerous spaces to work in should be cleared while there's zero time pressure. Start a donate/toss pile. Research movers or reserve a truck rental.

**4 WEEKS
OUT**

Pack rooms you rarely use: guest rooms, closets, seasonal items. Order any packing supplies you're short on. Confirm your moving date with movers or truck rental. Start using up pantry and freezer stock instead of buying more.

**2 WEEKS
OUT**

Book early-morning movers if you're hiring out — the good slots fill first in summer. Submit a change of address. Begin confirming utility activation at the new address. Line up childcare or pet care for moving day if needed.

1 WEEK OUT

Pack everything except daily essentials. Do your fridge, freezer, and pantry clear-out. Prepare your essentials bag (see page 5). Freeze water bottles for moving day. Confirm move-in time and access at the new property.

**MOVING
DAY**

Follow your hour-by-hour game plan (page 8). Hydrate before you're thirsty. Watch yourself and everyone helping for heat warning signs all day.

**FIRST WEEK
AFTER**

Confirm all utilities are active and working. Locate the water shut-off and breaker panel. Unpack the kitchen and bedrooms first. Give yourself permission to rest — a move takes more out of you than you expect, even after the truck's empty.

Houston Heat Survival

As a former nurse, this is the section I want every single person on your moving crew to actually read — not skim. Moving furniture in Houston heat is real physical exertion in real danger. Here's what to know, by the numbers and by the person.

Heat Exhaustion — Warning Stage	Heat Stroke — Emergency
☐ Heavy sweating ☐ Cold or clammy skin ☐ Fast, weak pulse ☐ Nausea, muscle cramps ☐ Tiredness, dizziness, headache	☐ Body temp above 103°F ☐ Hot, red, dry or damp skin ☐ Fast, strong pulse ☐ Confusion, slurred speech ☐ Nausea or loss of consciousness
Stop immediately. Move to shade or AC, sip water slowly, apply cool wet cloths, and rest until symptoms fully pass.	Call 911 immediately. Move to a cooler place, apply cool cloths to neck/armpits/groin. Don't give fluids if confused.

Hydration Strategy

Drink water before you're thirsty — thirst means you're already behind. Freeze water bottles the night before so they stay cold for hours instead of warming up in the sun. Keep electrolytes on hand, not just water; heavy sweating depletes more than hydration alone replaces.

Clothing & Sun Protection

Light-colored, breathable clothing. A hat. Sunscreen reapplied every couple of hours if you're in and out of direct sun all day. Cooling towels — wet, wrung out, draped around the neck — make a genuine difference over a long moving day.

Attic Safety

Houston attics get hotter than a car left in the sun — genuinely dangerous, and worse working alone. If you know your move is coming, clear the attic during spring or winter, not summer. If you're stuck doing it in the heat, move a little at a time with real breaks, or shift the work to nighttime once temperatures drop. Never do attic work alone if you can help it.

Medical Conditions & Vulnerable Groups

Medical Conditions That Change the Math

This is the part of moving-day advice most guides skip entirely, and as a former nurse, it's the part I actually want people to read. A couple of common conditions genuinely change how much risk a Houston summer move carries — and how fast things can turn.

Diabetes

Heat and dehydration can throw blood sugar off in both directions — dehydration tends to raise it, while heat can speed up insulin absorption in a way that risks a low. Check blood sugar more often than usual on moving day. Diabetic neuropathy can also dull the body's normal warning signs of overheating or an injury underfoot, so don't rely on how you feel alone — watch the clock and the thermometer too. And never leave insulin or other temperature-sensitive medications in a hot car or moving truck; a cooler (not direct ice, which can damage insulin too) is the safe way to transport it.

Hypohidrosis & Anhidrosis (Reduced or Absent Sweating)

Sweating is the body's primary cooling system. Without it working normally, the body can't bring its own temperature down during exertion, which makes heat exhaustion and heat stroke both more likely and faster to develop — sometimes with less warning than usual. This one is genuinely tricky because it can mask the danger: hot, dry skin is a heat stroke warning sign in most people, but for someone who doesn't sweat much to begin with, dry skin during hard work isn't unusual — so don't wait for sweat as your cue to slow down. If this applies to you, the honest, safest move is to hand off the heavy lifting entirely and take on lighter logistics instead, stay in air conditioning as much as possible, and use cooling towels and cold packs proactively rather than reactively.

Other conditions worth extra caution in Houston heat: heart disease, high blood pressure, and certain medications — diuretics, beta-blockers, and some antidepressants among them — can all affect how well the body handles heat and dehydration. If you're managing any chronic condition, it's worth a quick check-in with your doctor before a physically demanding day in extreme heat, moving day included.

Children

Never leave kids in a parked vehicle, even briefly. Set up a quiet, air-conditioned room away from the chaos with their favorite toys and any needed medication kept accessible, not packed.

Seniors

Older adults are more vulnerable to heat illness and often less likely to say so. Check in proactively, keep them in AC, don't let them handle heavy lifting in peak heat hours.

Pets

Never leave pets in a vehicle. Board them, or crate them in a closed-off, air-conditioned room with water available — an open front door all day is exactly how pets go missing.

Packing Smarter

A handful of tricks that save real time, real boxes, and real physical effort — especially in the heat.

The Dresser Trick

Instead of emptying every drawer into boxes, wrap the contents in place with plastic wrap — clothes and all — rolled a few times to hold everything secure, then pull the drawers out and set them aside. Your dresser becomes a fraction of the weight, easy for one or two people to carry, and you skip a whole round of boxing and unboxing entirely.

Freeze Water Bottles the Night Before

A freezer full of water bottles the night before moving day does double duty: cold water on hand all day as they thaw, and they help keep your cooler cold if you're using the fridge-packing method below.

Clear the Pantry Before You Pack It

Do a real fridge, freezer, and pantry clear-out at least 2-3 days before the move — toss anything expired, donate what's unused. The same goes for medicine cabinets and toiletries. If there's next to nothing left in a container, it's not worth packing.

Declutter Before You Pack, Not After

Every item you move in Houston heat is an item somebody has to carry, sweat over, and load twice. Anything expired, unused in a year, or kept out of guilt rather than actual use — donate it now. You'll thank yourself for every box you didn't have to move.

Protect Electronics & Medications

Pack electronics separately from general boxes, and photograph cords and connections before disconnecting anything — it saves real guesswork at the new house. Medications should stay climate-controlled and travel with you personally, never in a hot truck.

Moving Day Game Plan

An hour-by-hour framework — adjust the times to your own schedule, but keep the order. The core principle: heaviest work happens earliest, and the fridge is dead last on, first off.

6:00 AM	Wake, hydrate, eat a real breakfast. Load your essentials bag into your personal vehicle.
6:30 AM	Movers/crew arrives. Confirm the truck is parked in shade if at all possible, and confirm your carrying path is shaded where it can be.
6:45 AM	Begin loading — heaviest furniture and boxes first, while temperatures are lowest.
8:30 AM	First water/shade break. Check in with everyone helping — genuinely check in, not just a glance.
9:30 AM	Continue loading. Load the fridge cooler (packed per page 4) and cleaning supplies dead last.
10:30 AM	Truck loaded and padlocked. Final walkthrough of the old house — check every closet, cabinet, and the attic one last time.
11:00 AM	Depart for new address. Someone should have eyes on the truck at all times once stopped.
11:30 AM	Arrive. Turn the A/C on immediately — before anything else happens. Confirm utilities are active.
11:45 AM	Unload the fridge cooler first, into a fridge you've confirmed is cold and running.
12:00 PM	Begin unloading — label-matched to rooms. Take a real break before diving into unpacking.
Ongoing	Hydrate everyone all day. Photograph any damage to boxes or furniture as you unload, and inspect the truck itself before signing off with movers.

Houston-Specific Advice

A few things that catch people off guard specifically because they're moving in Houston, not just moving in summer.

Afternoon Thunderstorms

Houston summer afternoons bring fast-building, sometimes severe pop-up storms, often with little warning. Schedule your heaviest outdoor work for the morning, and have a plan to get anything weather-sensitive under cover quickly if the sky turns.

Humidity

Heat index — what it actually feels like — runs well above the thermometer reading in Houston's humidity. Plan around the heat index number, not just the temperature, when deciding how long anyone should be working outside.

Truck Theft Prevention

There is nowhere in the greater Houston metro where a loaded moving truck or a car full of belongings isn't a target — and summer is prime season, with families and college students moving in bulk. Keep eyes on the vehicle at all times, padlock it when unattended, and don't load valuables into a personal car until the last stretch of the move.

HOA, New Construction & Utilities

HOA Move-In Considerations

Many Houston-area master-planned communities have specific rules about moving truck size, permitted hours, and where trucks can park. Check your new community's HOA guidelines before moving day so you're not caught off guard by a restriction you didn't know existed.

New Construction Considerations

If you're moving into a new build, confirm your final walkthrough punch list is complete and documented before moving day — it's far easier to get outstanding items addressed before your furniture is filling the space. Also confirm the backyard situation: "landscaping included" often means less than buyers expect.

Utility Activation Checklist

- ☐ Electricity transferred or activated — confirmed before move-in day, not after
- ☐ Water/sewer set up with the municipality or MUD district
- ☐ Gas transferred if applicable
- ☐ Internet/cable installation scheduled
- ☐ Trash and recycling service confirmed
- ☐ Home security system transferred or newly set up

Emergency Quick Reference

CALL 911 IMMEDIATELY IF YOU SEE:

Body temperature above 103°F · hot, red, dry or damp skin · confusion or slurred speech · loss of consciousness · a fast, strong pulse combined with any of the above. This is heat stroke. It escalates fast — don't wait to see if it passes.

While Waiting for Help

- Move the person to a cooler space immediately
- Apply cool cloths or ice packs to neck, armpits, and groin
- Do NOT give fluids if the person is confused or losing consciousness — risk of choking
- Stay with them until help arrives

Save These Numbers Before Moving Day

- Emergency: **911**
- Poison Control: **1-800-222-1222**
- Moving company / crew lead contact
- New property's utility providers (electric, water, gas)
- HOA emergency contact, if applicable
- A trusted neighbor or friend near the new address

Keep this page somewhere accessible on moving day — a phone screenshot works, but a printed copy taped inside the truck cab doesn't need battery life.

Before Moving Day & Heat Safety

Before Moving Day

- ☐ Book early morning movers
- ☐ Begin packing weeks ahead
- ☐ Empty the attic before summer if possible
- ☐ Donate before packing
- ☐ Clear refrigerator/freezer
- ☐ Prepare an essentials bag
- ☐ Freeze water bottles
- ☐ Confirm utilities

Heat Safety

- ☐ Hydrate before you're thirsty
- ☐ Electrolytes available
- ☐ Cooling towels
- ☐ Sunscreen
- ☐ Hat
- ☐ Take breaks every 20-30 minutes
- ☐ Know heat exhaustion symptoms
- ☐ Know heat stroke warning signs
- ☐ Emergency numbers saved

Kids, Pets & Belongings

Kids & Pets

- ☐ Never leave in vehicles
- ☐ Quiet air-conditioned room
- ☐ Water bowls ready
- ☐ Favorite toys packed separately
- ☐ Medication accessible

Protect Your Belongings

- ☐ Electronics packed separately
- ☐ Candles removed
- ☐ Medications climate controlled
- ☐ Documents carried personally
- ☐ Jewelry never on moving truck
- ☐ Lock truck during loading
- ☐ Park truck where visible

Loading & Arrival

Loading Strategy

- ☐ Heavy items first
- ☐ Last-in / first-out essentials
- ☐ Dressers wrapped instead of emptying drawers
- ☐ Label every room
- ☐ Photograph electronics before disconnecting

Arrival

- ☐ Turn A/C on immediately
- ☐ Check utilities
- ☐ Inspect moving truck before signing
- ☐ Photograph damage
- ☐ Hydrate everyone
- ☐ Take a break before unpacking

BONUS

Fay's Top 10 Houston Summer Moving Tips

- | | |
|----|--|
| 01 | If you can, load the truck overnight and save the morning for unloading — skips the worst heat of the day entirely. |
| 02 | Wrap dresser drawers in plastic instead of emptying them. Lighter furniture, fewer boxes. |
| 03 | Pack your fridge cooler dead last, unload it first — frozen items on the edges, refrigerated in the middle, ice filling every gap. |
| 04 | Never do attic work alone in summer heat. It's hotter up there than a closed car, and help can't reach you fast if something goes wrong. |
| 05 | Take off your jewelry before lifting a single box — broken rings and smashed fingers send people to the ER mid-move. |
| 06 | Freeze water bottles the night before — cold water for hours, and a backup ice source for your cooler. |
| 07 | Anything truly irreplaceable goes to storage, a trusted friend, or a safety deposit box before moving day — never on the truck. |
| 08 | Someone should always have eyes on a loaded truck. Padlock it the moment it's full and unattended. |
| 09 | Pace yourself like it's a workday, not a sprint — real breaks in shade or AC, every 20 to 30 minutes. |
| 10 | A move is not worth an ER visit. In a Houston summer, that's not a hypothetical — it happens to people who think they're just pushing through being tired. |

Moving This Summer?

Whether you're buying, selling, or just trying to time a move around Houston heat, I'm happy to talk through what actually makes sense for your situation — no pressure, no obligation.



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